

I chose to write and record a song for my final assignment. It took me awhile to decide on a topic to write the song about since there are so many different issues that we discussed, and many of them strike a chord deep within me.

After many attempts at writing lyrics about various topics, I decided to just relax, listen to the music I had written and allow words to come to me without being forced. I alluded to you earlier in the semester that I have a family member that spent time in several B.C. penitentiaries. While I have always wanted to write a song about his experience, as well as my family's experience throughout the ordeal, I decided that this is not the time because I wanted the song to be less about my life and more about the current situation faced by many prisoners today.

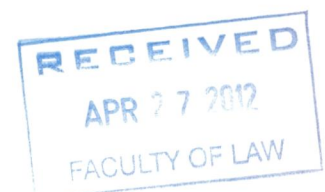
I will not describe my interpretation of the lyrics in any depth here, as I think that song lyrics should be interpreted by the listener in a way that allows them to connect to the song based on whatever personal experiences they have had in their lives. I will just give a brief description of where my thoughts were at when writing it.

I hope you enjoy the song. I am including a copy in CD format, but I will also post a link online where you and others can download it. I will email the link to you as soon as I upload the song.

Thank you for the wonderful semester and for opening my eyes to topics I had been ignoring for some time.

Best Regards,

Tarek



Prison State

I can still recall his smile
The smell of Captain Black and when you put him on trial

But when you took him away
That was the day
My dreams of technicolour turned to grey
I lost a piece of my heart
And I'll never get it back again

Every time you steal a man away from his home
He won't be the only one alone
And every time that you deny a man of his soul
Another rebel child is born

So when you tell us that the only way
To a safer place
Is a prison state

Are you prepared to make amends to all the lives you'll save
By locking hearts in concrete graves

You teach me to respect authority
About the rule of law and sanctity

Well you may be right
But it's hard to fight
When I see your actions overwrite
Every principle that
That lies beneath the laws you've made

Every time you steal a man away from his home
He won't be the only one alone
And every time that you deny a man of his soul
Another rebel child is born

So when you tell us that the only way

To a safer place
Is a prison state

Are you prepared to make amends to all the lives you'll save
By locking hearts in concrete graves

I'd like to
Know
How you draw the line and say that someone's
Soul
Has to earn the right to breathe and fight
Why don't you
Try
To walk in his shoes for just one day

Every time you steal a man away from his home
And every time that you deny a man of his soul

Every time you steal a man away from his home
He won't be the only one alone
And every time that you deny a man of his soul
Another rebel child is born

So when you tell us that the only way
To a safer place
Is a prison state

Are you prepared to make amends to all the lives you'll save
By locking hearts in concrete graves